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"It's not fair," Savoca complains.
 "Yankee management could
 have done a much better job of distrib-
 uting these tickets."

Filmmaker says he has tape proving UFOs visited in '65

By NEIL A. SHEEHAN
STAFF WRITER

SUBMITTED FOR your approval: Samuel Sherman's account of a close encounter between some UFOs and an Air Force base in California one October night almost three decades ago.

Forget about "Independence Day," the summer blockbuster in which aliens flying ships the size of Connecticut decimate the White House, not to mention several major cities. Ditto for TV's "The X-Files," with agents Scully and Mulder forever chasing cases of paranormal weirdness, or the whimsical sitcom "Third Rock from the Sun."

Sherman insists that if you want the true lowdown on a brush with extraterrestrials, you'll need to listen to the new "audio documentary" he's produced titled "The Edwards Air Force Encounter."

Of course, very little in the cosmos

is free anymore, so you'll need to pony up \$14.95, plus \$2 for postage and handling, for the privilege.

"People say: 'You're crazy. There are no UFOs.' But this is the real McCoy," says Sherman, a producer of B horror movies from Old Bridge Township who dabbles in a number of other ventures. He will speak about his unidentified flying object findings at 7 p.m. tomorrow at the Wall Township Library, off Allaire Road in the municipal complex.

Here's what he has to offer on a subject that has commanded much attention in recent months, most notably in the wake of some NASA scientists' claim that they have discovered evidence of a primitive, earlier form of life on Mars: a compilation of declassified Air Force recordings that he says prove Edwards Air Force Base, in California, had a run-in with as many as a dozen UFOs on Oct. 7, 1965.

"It's sort of a stunning event. And



Sherman

On the tapes, which Sherman says took eight months of editing to make sense, air traffic controllers are heard frantically discussing the spaceships, he says. "You hear someone saying, 'Well, what are you seeing?' Then, someone else shouting, 'I see one over the runway!' You hear five bases talking about sending up interceptors," he says.

Sherman says he stumbled across

until I went after it, no one knew about it. It was a footnote in history," he says. "I have absolutely carved out a piece of history that I own."

the tapes while working on a docudrama about UFOs called "Beyond the Earth" in the early 1990s. After talking to sources of UFO information, it was suggested he delve into what the Air Force had declassified.

"I'm now convinced there are UFOs because I have evidence. This planet is being visited by intelligent beings from places unknown."

"My tape," he declares, "is the clincher."

An Air Force spokesman, Capt. Byron James, was not aware of specific recordings obtained by Sherman. However, he says that "as far as the Air Force is concerned, there has been nothing released that confirms a meeting with UFOs."

"If he (Sherman) drew that conclusion, well, that's up to him," James adds.

Perhaps it's because we're approaching the start of a new millennium that interest in aliens appears to be at a fever pitch. Besides movies, TV shows and books on the subject, a poll conducted by Newsweek magazine earlier this year found that 48 percent of Americans believe UFOs exist.

The poll also found that 29 percent of Americans think contact has been established between denizens of planet Earth and folks from outer space.

Julia Mason, a retired library researcher, has been collecting information about UFO sightings in New Jersey for years. She estimates at least 95 percent of the reports can be attributed to something other than extraterrestrials.

"For me, they could be explained

by scientific or military experiments, weather balloons, even a low-flying plane out of McGuire (Air Force Base)," says Mason of Manchester Township.

She has counted about 20 sightings in the state, most of them in the 1950s, a time when science fiction enjoyed great popularity in the United States.

When people report sightings, she says, it's usually not because they're trying to be misleading. They truly believe what they're seeing is from outer space. "People are always wishing for something better, an outer dimension where things are better," Mason says.

In addition to his recording, Sherman would like to use the information he has obtained to develop a two-hour documentary, complete with a celebrity voiceover, as well as a book and interactive CD on the topic.

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